The Thief's Story Summary

The Thief's 'Story is a story about **Hari Singh**, a fifteen-year-old thief, and **Anil**, a kind and trusting young man.

Hari Singh meets Anil at a wrestling match and decides to become his servant. He lies about his name and cooking skills. Anil gives him food and teaches him **reading, writing and arithmetic**. Hari also secretly makes a small profit while buying household supplies.

One day, Anil receives **₹600** after selling a book and keeps the money under his mattress. Hari decides to steal it. He takes the money and goes to the railway station to catch a train to Lucknow. However, he hesitates and misses the train.

While sitting in the rain, Hari realises that Anil's **trust and education** are more valuable than stolen money. He returns to Anil's room and puts the money back under the mattress.

The next morning, Anil gives Hari **₹50** and says that he will pay him regularly. Hari notices that the note is wet from the rain. This makes it clear that **Anil knew about the theft but chose to forgive him**.

The story shows that **trust, education, kindness and forgiveness can transform a person**.

Main Themes

- Trust and betrayal
- Importance of education
- Kindness and forgiveness
- Transformation of a person
- Money vs. education and respect

Important Characters

Hari Singh:

A 15-year-old experienced thief who lies and cheats but eventually changes because of Anil's trust and kindness.

Anil:

A young, simple, kind and trusting man. He gives Hari food, shelter, education and a chance to become a better person.

Q1. Who does 'I' refer to in this story?

Answer:

‘ I’ refers to **Hari Singh**, the fifteen-year-old narrator of the story. He is an experienced thief who later decides to change his life because of Anil's kindness and trust.

Q2. What is he “a fairly successful hand” at?

Answer:

He is a **fairly successful thief**. He has experience in stealing and is clever enough to avoid being caught by the police.

Q3. What does he get from Anil in return for his work?

Answer:

At first, Hari gets **food and shelter** from Anil. Anil also teaches him **reading, writing and arithmetic**, which becomes more valuable to Hari than money.

Q4. Does Anil realise that he has been robbed?

Answer:

Yes, Anil realises that Hari has stolen the money. The wet ₹50 note shows that he knows Hari had taken the

money and returned it. However, he does not confront Hari because he wants to give him a chance to change.

Q5. Why did Hari Singh change his name every month?

Answer:

Hari Singh changed his name every month to **avoid the police and his former employers**. Since he was a thief, changing names helped him escape identification and continue his dishonest activities.

Q6. Why was it difficult for Hari to rob Anil?

Answer:

It was difficult for Hari to rob Anil because **Anil trusted him completely**. He gave Hari a key to the room and allowed him to come and go freely. Hari felt that stealing from such a trusting person would mean betraying his trust.

Q7. Why did Hari Singh return the stolen money?

Answer:

Hari returned the money because he realised that **education and Anil's trust were more valuable than**

₹600. He understood that learning to read and write could help him earn money honestly and become a respected person.

Q8. How did Anil change Hari Singh?

Answer:

Anil changed Hari through his **kindness, trust and willingness to educate him**. Instead of punishing Hari for stealing, he silently forgave him and continued teaching him. This made Hari realise the value of honesty and education.

Q9. What is the significance of the wet ₹ 50 note?

Answer:

The wet ₹50 note proves that **Anil knew Hari had stolen and returned the money**. He deliberately did not expose Hari. His silence shows his kindness, forgiveness and trust in Hari's ability to change.

10. How did Anil's kindness change Hari Singh?

Answer:

Anil's kindness changed Hari Singh completely. Anil gave him food, shelter and trusted him without suspicion. He also taught Hari to read, write and do simple calculations. When Hari stole ₹600, Anil did not

punish him. His trust and forgiveness made Hari realise that education and honesty were more valuable than stolen money. Thus, Anil helped Hari become a better person.

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11. Why did Hari Singh decide to return the stolen money?

Answer:

Hari Singh decided to return the stolen money because he realised that money could give him comfort only for a short time. He understood that learning to read and write could help him earn money honestly in the future. He also felt guilty about betraying Anil's trust. Therefore, he returned the ₹600 to Anil.

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12. Describe the character of Anil.

Answer:

Anil was a **kind, simple, generous and trusting** young man. He gave Hari food and shelter even though he could not pay him regularly. He taught Hari reading,

writing and arithmetic. He trusted Hari completely and gave him a key to his room. Even after discovering the theft, he silently forgave Hari. Thus, Anil was understanding and compassionate.

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13. Describe the character of Hari Singh.

Answer:

Hari Singh was a **fifteen-year-old experienced thief**. He was clever, dishonest and good at cheating people. However, he was also capable of understanding kindness. Anil's trust and affection slowly changed him. After stealing ₹600, Hari realised the value of education and returned the money. Thus, he was a thief who had the potential to become an honest and respectable person.

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14. What is the message of *The Thief's Story*?

Answer:

The story gives the message that **trust, kindness, education and forgiveness can change a person's life**.

Hari Singh was a thief, but Anil treated him with love and trust instead of suspicion. Education gave Hari hope for a better future. The story shows that a person can change when given a second chance.

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15. Why was education more valuable to Hari than the stolen money?

Answer:

The stolen money could provide Hari with comfort for only a short time. On the other hand, education could help him earn money honestly throughout his life. Hari realised that knowing how to read, write and calculate could make him a **clever, respected and successful person**. Therefore, he chose education over the ₹600 he had stolen.

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16. How did Anil show that he knew about the theft?

Answer:

The next morning, Anil gave Hari a **₹50 note** and said that he would pay him regularly. Hari noticed that the

note was still wet from the rain. This showed that Anil knew that Hari had taken the money and returned it during the rainy night. However, Anil did not question or punish him. His silence showed his forgiveness and trust.

Q17. What does the thief say about the different reactions of people when they are robbed?

Answer:

The thief says that people react differently when they are robbed. A **greedy man shows fear** because he is afraid of losing his money. A **rich man shows anger** because he can afford the loss. A **poor man shows acceptance** because he knows that he cannot do much about it. However, Hari thinks that Anil would show **sadness, not for losing the money but for losing his trust**.